

FanVerdict Product Roadmap

From FanVerdict 1.0 to a social, mobile-first prediction platform

Audience: Founder/product owner, future engineering contributors, tournament administrators

Scope: Product improvement opportunities, feature roadmap, release themes, risks, and success metrics

Baseline: FanVerdict 1.0: live tournaments, polls, votes, standings, reminders, historical standings, and private leagues

Planning note: Roadmap is directional. Exact release contents should be gated by testing, usage data, and operational capacity.

Executive recommendation

Treat FanVerdict 2.0 as the social growth release, not just a feature release. The strongest path is to make private leagues, friend invites, reminders, and shareable standings feel effortless before expanding into native mobile apps, automation, monetization, or AI features.

1. Current Product Assessment

FanVerdict 1.0 already has a meaningful foundation: a tournament prediction workflow, structured polls, authenticated voting, standings, reminders, historical standings, account settings, and private leagues. This is enough to prove the core idea with a real group.

The main opportunity is to move from a functional prediction app to a repeat-use fan habit. That requires better invite loops, stronger mobile experience, reliable communication, admin automation, and lightweight community mechanics.

Area	What is solid today	Room for improvement
Core game loop	Users can join tournaments, vote on polls, and see standings.	Voting should become faster on mobile, more reminder-driven, and more emotionally rewarding after results settle.
Private leagues	Release 1 and Release 2 create the base for smaller groups and friend invites.	Admins need invite tracking, league activity history, abuse controls, and post-tournament archives.
Communication	Daily reminder emails exist and in-app spam guidance was added.	Move beyond Gmail SMTP toward domain-authenticated transactional email, push notifications, and per-user reminder preferences.
Administration	Admins can operate tournaments and historical imports.	Poll creation, schedule import, result settlement, and moderation should become more automated.
Mobile readiness	The web app is usable, and the app-store path has been documented.	A PWA/native wrapper, push notifications, app icons, privacy disclosures, and app-store QA are needed.
Trust and scale	Supabase auth, RLS, and audit-log concepts are present.	Add automated tests, monitoring, rate limits, invite abuse protection, backups, and operational dashboards.

2. Product North Star

North star

FanVerdict should become the easiest way for a fan group to run prediction competitions around live tournaments, with trusted scoring, low-friction invites, private league identity, and reminders that bring people back before every lock time.

Guiding product principles:

- Keep the main tournament as the source of truth. Private leagues should filter and compare, not create separate point logic unless a later rules engine explicitly supports it.
- Make social growth native. Every standings page, private league, and settled result should have a clean share or invite path.
- Design mobile-first. Most voting and reminder actions will happen on phones, especially once friend invites expand the audience.
- Protect trust. Participants must believe votes, timestamps, scoring, and admin actions are transparent and auditable.
- Avoid platform sprawl too early. Build native apps and monetization after retention and invite conversion are measurable.

3. Version Roadmap Overview

Version	Theme	Primary goal	Headline capabilities
1.5	Stabilization bridge	Make 1.0 reliable enough for broader usage.	Email deliverability, test coverage, RLS audit, mobile polish, analytics baseline.
2.0	Social growth and private leagues	Turn private groups and friend invites into the growth engine.	Email invites, invite management, league admin tools, share/export, moderation, discoverability.
3.0	Mobile-native engagement	Make FanVerdict a phone-first habit.	PWA/native apps, push notifications, live updates, reminder center, mobile voting speed.
4.0	Tournament platform automation	Reduce admin effort and support more tournaments.	Templates, fixture import, automated poll generation, result settlement, rules engine, admin analytics.
5.0	Community and monetization	Create durable communities and revenue options.	Community pages, achievements, referrals, premium leagues, sponsorship surfaces, public league directory.
6.0+	Intelligence and ecosystem	Use data and integrations to differentiate.	Prediction insights, AI admin assistant, anomaly detection, API, white-label, partner integrations.

4. Recommended Release Path

FanVerdict 1.5: Stabilization and product polish

Target outcome

Before a broad 2.0 push, harden the app so new users invited by friends have a smooth first session and administrators are not fighting operational issues.

Priority features:

- Replace or supplement Gmail SMTP with a transactional provider and authenticated sending domain using SPF, DKIM, and DMARC.
- Add basic product analytics for signup, tournament join, vote submitted, invite sent, invite accepted, league created, and reminder clicked.
- Improve mobile form layouts and reduce friction in the vote submission path.
- Add visible loading and empty states for tournament, private league, and invite views.
- Add a small automated test suite around scoring, invite acceptance, RLS assumptions, and cron reminders.

Admin and operations impact:

- Create an operational checklist for every tournament launch.
- Add monitoring for failed reminder emails, failed invite emails, and Supabase API errors.
- Document how to run migrations and verify production environment variables after deployment.

Readiness metrics:

- At least 95 percent of invited users can create/sign in and reach the tournament without manual help.
- Daily reminder failure rate is visible and below an agreed threshold.
- No known RLS gap allows a participant to see or mutate private league data outside their permissions.

FanVerdict 2.0: Social growth and private leagues

Target outcome

Make private leagues the first real network effect. Participants should be able to form small groups, invite friends, track league-specific standings, and share results confidently.

Priority features:

- Complete friend invite flow: email invite, signup/sign-in redirect, automatic tournament enrollment, and automatic private league membership.
- Add invite management for league admins: pending, accepted, expired, resend, revoke, and copied invite link status.
- Add a dashboard-level Invite Friends entry point for any participant, with clear guidance to create or select a private league first.
- Add league archive views after tournament completion: final standings, member list, export, and shareable read-only link.
- Add basic invite abuse controls: rate limits, resend limits, blocked domains if needed, and audit log review for tournament admins.
- Improve private league discovery: listed/unlisted filters, request status, admin approval queue, and clear tournament-admin visibility for unlisted leagues.

Admin and operations impact:

- Tournament admins can view all private leagues, including unlisted leagues, and spot problematic names/descriptions.
- Private league admins can manage members and requests without affecting tournament membership or votes.
- Support staff can answer who invited whom, when, and whether the invite was accepted.

Readiness metrics:

- Invite acceptance conversion rate is measurable and improving.
- Average leagues created per active tournament is above the product target.
- Private league participants vote at a higher rate than non-private-league participants.

FanVerdict 3.0: Mobile-native engagement

Target outcome

Turn FanVerdict into a phone-first experience that brings people back before polls lock and after results settle.

Priority features:

- Launch PWA install flow first, then native iOS/Android wrappers if usage supports store investment.
- Add push notifications for picks due, invite received, join request approved, result settled, rank changed, and league admin requests.
- Add a personal home feed: picks due next, latest settled polls, rank movement, private league activity, and friend invites.
- Add real-time or near-real-time standings refresh after polls settle and after votes are counted.
- Add calendar integration or add-to-calendar reminders for major match/poll lock times.
- Add mobile voting shortcuts: one-tap vote, confirmation, edit-until-lock, and compact poll cards.

Admin and operations impact:

- Admins can send targeted tournament announcements without editing code or running scripts.
- Support can diagnose notification delivery across email and push channels.
- App-store assets, privacy labels, terms, and support contact are maintained as release artifacts.

Readiness metrics:

- Mobile users complete a vote in fewer interactions than 1.0.
- Push-enabled users have higher vote completion than email-only users.
- App install or PWA install rate is high enough to justify continued native investment.

FanVerdict 4.0: Tournament platform automation

Target outcome

Make it practical to run more tournaments, more sports, and more poll formats without manual admin burden.

Priority features:

- Add tournament templates: FIFA, IPL, March Madness-style brackets, playoffs, season-long contests, and custom pools.
- Add fixture import from CSV first, then optional sports-data provider integrations when licensing and cost make sense.
- Add poll templates and generation rules: winner, margin, top scorer, bonus questions, bracket outcomes, and custom options.

- Add a scoring rules engine with versioned rules, auditability, and clear backward compatibility for historical tournaments.
- Add automated result settlement workflow: suggested result, admin review, settlement, recalculation, and notification.
- Add admin analytics: participation, missed votes, reminder effectiveness, private league activity, and tournament health.

Admin and operations impact:

- Tournament admins spend less time creating polls and settling outcomes.
- App admins can import, clone, archive, and restore tournaments safely.
- Rules and settlement changes are logged clearly enough to resolve disputes.

Readiness metrics:

- Time to launch a new tournament drops materially.
- Manual poll setup errors decline.
- Settlement-to-notification time becomes predictable.

FanVerdict 5.0: Community, retention, and monetization

Target outcome

Move from tournament utility to fan community platform, with revenue options that do not damage trust.

Priority features:

- Add persistent groups or communities that can run multiple tournaments over time.
- Add achievements, streaks, rank movement badges, and season summaries without turning scoring into gimmicks.
- Add referral loops: invite friend, league growth milestones, and shareable result cards.
- Add premium league options: custom branding, advanced exports, larger member limits, private archive pages, and admin analytics.
- Add sponsor surfaces cautiously: tournament sponsor banner, prize sponsor note, or community sponsor card with clear separation from scoring.
- Add public league directory for listed leagues, with moderation, reporting, and request-to-join controls.

Admin and operations impact:

- Admins can run communities across seasons instead of recreating structure every tournament.
- Owner can test monetization without forcing payment into the core free prediction flow.
- Moderation tools are strong enough for public discovery.

Readiness metrics:

- Repeat tournament participation increases season over season.
- Communities create more than one tournament without owner intervention.
- Premium conversion or sponsor interest is visible before heavy monetization investment.

FanVerdict 6.0+: Intelligence and ecosystem expansion

Target outcome

Differentiate with insight, automation, and integrations once the user base and data justify the complexity.

Priority features:

- Add AI-assisted admin tools: generate poll ideas, draft tournament announcements, summarize league activity, and flag missing setup steps.
- Add personal insights: pick history, strengths by category, missed-vote patterns, and friendly matchup comparisons.
- Add anomaly and dispute tools: unusual vote timing, settlement changes, duplicate account risk, and admin action review.
- Add partner/API capabilities for external sites, fan groups, podcasts, schools, or workplaces that want prediction leagues.
- Explore white-label or multi-tenant packages only after core operations are reliable and repeatable.

Admin and operations impact:

- Admin work becomes assisted rather than manual.
- Data becomes a product advantage, not just a leaderboard output.
- External partners can create growth without custom code for every tournament.

Readiness metrics:

- AI features save measurable admin time or increase engagement.
- API/partner use cases produce repeatable demand.
- Security, privacy, and data controls remain strong under broader distribution.

5. Feature Backlog by Product Area

Product area	High-value features	Priority
Onboarding and growth	Invite tracking, account creation redirect, referral link, first-tournament checklist, friend import later.	High for 2.0
Notifications	Email deliverability, push, digest settings, quiet hours, lock-time reminders, result-settled notifications.	High for 3.0
Private leagues	Archive, admin invite list, revoke/resend, join request history, public directory, moderation queue.	High for 2.0 and 5.0
Voting experience	Fast mobile cards, edit-until-lock clarity, confirmation, missed-vote recovery, poll grouping by lock time.	High for 1.5 and 3.0
Admin tooling	Templates, fixture import, poll generator, settlement review, audit dashboard, admin analytics.	High for 4.0
Historical data	Private league history, claimed profile continuity, year-over-year records, season summaries.	Medium for 2.0 to 4.0
Trust and safety	Rate limits, profanity moderation, report league, suspicious account review, terms/privacy flow.	High before public discovery
Monetization	Premium league features, sponsorship placements, community tiers, export packs, white-label later.	Medium after retention proof

Product area	High-value features	Priority
Data and insights	Cohorts, invite funnel, vote completion, notification effectiveness, league engagement, admin effort.	High as an internal capability

6. Risks and Dependencies

Risk or dependency	Why it matters	Recommended control
Email deliverability	Gmail-sent reminders and invites can land in spam, hurting activation and retention.	Use authenticated domain email, monitor bounces, add unsubscribe/notification settings, keep in-app spam guidance.
Invite spam or abuse	Friend invites and public discovery can be misused.	Add rate limits, revoke/resend status, audit logs, content moderation, and admin reporting.
Sports data licensing	Automated schedules/results may require paid providers and usage restrictions.	Start with CSV import and manual settlement; integrate providers only with clear cost and licensing.
App store obligations	Native apps require developer accounts, privacy labels, review compliance, support URLs, and release process.	Start with PWA; move to iOS/Android when mobile retention supports the overhead.
Scoring disputes	Wrong settlements or rule changes can damage trust.	Use audit logs, versioned scoring rules, settlement review, and transparent recalculation history.
Feature sprawl	Too many social or AI features can distract from the core prediction loop.	Gate releases by activation, invite conversion, vote completion, and repeat tournament participation.
Security and RLS	Service-role APIs and private league visibility must be carefully guarded.	Keep service-role logic server-only, add tests for RLS, and review each new table policy before production.

7. Success Metrics

The roadmap should be measured through product outcomes, not just shipped features. Recommended metrics:

- Activation: percent of invited users who create/sign in, join the tournament, and submit at least one vote.
- Invite funnel: invites sent, delivered, opened/clicked, accepted, expired, and revoked.
- Engagement: vote completion rate, missed-vote rate, reminders clicked, result-settled page visits, and private league page visits.
- Retention: participants returning for the next tournament, communities running multiple tournaments, and repeat private league creation.
- Admin efficiency: time to launch a tournament, time to create polls, settlement time, support incidents, and migration/deployment defects.
- Reliability: email failures, API errors, cron failures, slow page loads, and failed invite acceptance attempts.
- Monetization readiness: sponsor interest, premium feature usage, willingness to pay, and growth in community-managed tournaments.

8. Suggested Next 90 Days

1. Finish testing the Release 2 email-invite flow end to end, including existing-user acceptance, new-user signup, expired token, wrong email, and private league admin permissions.
2. Apply the Release 2 migration in Supabase and verify production environment variables for Gmail SMTP, Supabase service role, and app base URL.
3. Add invite management visibility for private league admins so they can see pending/accepted/expired friend invites.
4. Move email sending toward a custom authenticated domain and a transactional email provider when ready.
5. Add minimal product analytics for signup, join tournament, vote, invite sent, invite accepted, league created, and reminder clicked.
6. Create a small automated regression suite around scoring, private league membership, invite acceptance, and reminder jobs.
7. Plan the 3.0 mobile path: PWA first, then native app store packaging if usage validates it.

9. Decision Points Before 3.0

Decision	Options	Recommended default
Mobile strategy	PWA only, native wrapper, or full native app.	PWA first, native wrapper after retention and push need are proven.
Notification stack	Email only, email plus push, email plus SMS/WhatsApp.	Email plus push for 3.0; SMS/WhatsApp only if groups demand it.
Sports data	Manual, CSV import, paid API integration.	CSV import and admin settlement first; paid API later.
Monetization	Free only, sponsors, premium leagues, white-label.	Premium admin features and sponsorship experiments after retention proof.
Community model	Tournament-only leagues or persistent communities.	Persistent communities in 5.0 once private league reuse is validated.

10. Bottom Line

FanVerdict should not rush straight from a working 1.0 into every possible social, mobile, data, and monetization feature. The best path is staged: harden the core, make private leagues and friend invites excellent, then invest in mobile-native engagement, then automate tournament operations, then expand into community and monetization.

If FanVerdict 2.0 can prove that private leagues increase invite conversion and vote completion, the product has a credible path toward a broader platform. If that proof is weak, the next investment should be onboarding, reminders, and tournament operations before larger app-store or monetization work.